

Harshdeep Athawale

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EDUCATION

Thapar Institute of Engineering & Technology
B.E. in Computer Engineering

Patiala, India
Aug. 2024 – June 2028

EXPERIENCE

Iris Intelligence

April. 2026 – June. 2026

Security Engineer (Internship)

Delhi, India (Hybrid)

- Performed **vulnerability assessments** across REST APIs, authentication flows, and the sandboxed code-execution layer, surfacing broken access control, injection, and cross-tenant data-leakage gaps and driving remediation before launch.
- Authored **SOC 2 and ISO 27001 compliance** documentation with privacy-by-design controls (data classification, encryption, retention), establishing the company's GRC baseline.
- Hardened request rate limiting and agent runtime restrictions to keep workloads isolated and abuse-resistant as the platform **securely scaled to 5K+ concurrent users**.

HackerOne

Dec. 2025 – March. 2026

Security Researcher (Part-time)

San Francisco, CA (Remote)

- Submitted **35+ vulnerability reports** to global programs including Goldman Sachs, Flipkart, Adobe, Netflix, Red Bull, NVIDIA, Anduril, Coca-Cola, and Superdrug – headlined by a **Critical (CVSS 9.1)** GraphQL flaw at Red Bull exposing employee PII, and an unauthenticated API exposing 892 employees PII with write access to a production database.
- Found high-impact **infra and supply-chain** bugs: remote code execution in a build pipeline, a subdomain takeover at Anduril, and exposed source maps leaking OAuth secrets at Flipkart/Myntra.
- Discovered **hardcoded OAuth secrets** leaking NHS medical data and an appointment IDOR at Superdrug, preventing potential patients data breaches

PROJECTS

Transformer-Based AI WAF Pipeline | *Python, FastAPI, PyTorch, ONNX*

GitHub | Jan. 2026 – Present

- Built a reverse-proxy AI WAF combining Redis rate limiting, DDoS detection, bot scoring, and transformer-based request inspection, outperforming **ModSecurity OWASP CRS v4** (96% vs 46%) on 675 real-world payloads.
- Fine-tuned **DistilBERT** for 10 web attack classes, achieving **97.5% detection** on Path Traversal, XXE, SSRF, and LDAP/XPath Injection through training–inference alignment and hard-negative mining.
- Reduced inference latency by **8×** (46 ms → 6 ms p50) using ONNX Runtime and deployed as a multi-tenant FastAPI service with monitor, block, and challenge modes.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, Bash, C++

Security Tools: Burp Suite, Nmap, Metasploit, OWASP ZAP, sqlmap, Nuclei, MobSF, Frida, JADX, Wireshark, Shodan

Frameworks & Methodologies: MITRE ATT&CK, Cyber Kill Chain, OWASP Top 10, OWASP MASVS, STRIDE Threat Modeling

Governance, Risk & Compliance: SOC 2 Type II, ISO 27001, Privacy-by-Design, Risk Assessment, Security Policy Drafting

Infra & DevOps: Docker, CI/CD, GitHub Actions, AWS, NGINX, Linux, Git; PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, SQL

Networking: OSI Model, TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, Firewalls, IDS/IPS

ACHIEVEMENTS

Ranked Top **1%** Worldwide on TryHackMe (India Rank **#2,052**), **300+** day streak, **230+** labs solved.

Intigriti Hall of Fame - Earned 4 severity badges: Exceptional (4×), Critical (3×), Medium (2×), and First Valid Submission.

National Runner-Up (2nd Place) at the **PSB Hackathon Series 2026** – organized by the Government of India with Central Bank of India & MNNIT Allahabad – outlasting **226 teams** to win an **INR 3,00,000** cash prize as part of Team Dhurandhar.